

Barclay

He understands the headline. He also pays the bill.



The gentleman paying the bill

SPECIES

Golden retriever

AGE

Mid-forties

PERSONALITY

- Mature, self-assured and good-humored
- Practical about money without being cynical about people
- Soft-featured and approachable, never puppyish

He feels the absurdity in his wallet.

Background & place in the story

Barclay is a successful gentleman and unmistakably a golden retriever. He understands money, but experience has not made him immune to surprise at what things cost. The familiar company at The Swinging Door gives him room to say the practical thing everyone else is thinking.

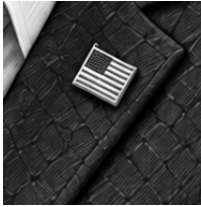
He brings the news down to the scale of a household, a purchase or a receipt. The joke does not depend on making him foolish: his dignity is precisely what makes the observation land. His current expression is confident, happy and warm. Financial concerns may drive a line, but a sad or confused face is not his default.

Current portrait: 1024 x 1536 pixels, placed at approximately 287 PPI. No upscaling.

Signature details.

The small things that make this character unmistakable.

The American flag lapel pin



A permanent small flag on his left lapel, or left chest when he is not wearing a jacket. The dark canton and alternating stripes must remain recognizable in black and white; the pin is attached to the cloth, not floating above it.



A mature, warm retriever face

A black nose and dog lip line, softly freckled muzzle and expressive eyes with visible whites. Short natural crown fur and a modest neck ruff keep him groomed and upright, without a human hairstyle or an oversized neck beard.



Soft furry hands and a wristwatch

Broad, fur-backed hands articulate like hands: fingers and an opposed thumb, with soft fingertips and no visible nails or claws. A plain wristwatch and relaxed jacket complete the gentleman's silhouette.

Unretouched details from the current presentation portrait. Crops reveal existing marks; they do not add resolution.

In the conversation.

One speaker. Every listener knows who has the floor.



Speaking to Drew

Mouth open; gaze toward Drew. His expression remains warm and assured.



Listening to Drew

Mouth closed; eyes on Drew, retaining the relaxed, mature face.



Listening to Abby

Mouth closed; attention lifts toward Abby while she has the last word.

Facial acting crops from current Best Of masters, not retired concept sheets or newly invented full-body gestures.

How Barclay speaks

- Speak from his own experience or wallet.
- Prefer a concrete purchase, bill or everyday consequence to financial jargon.
- Let him be candid and dignified at the same time.

Relationships

Drew. Drew sees the system; Barclay feels its consequences in his wallet. Neither is the other's fool. Their friendship gives the joke a human scale.

Abby. He respects the owner of the room. Her matter-of-fact answer can settle a debate that even his most sensible question could not.

Keep consistent

- Frame-right; seated upright with believable clearance from the bar.
- Dark jacket over a pale open-collared shirt, without a tie.
- Old fashioned in a short rocks glass, with one large cube and a dark cherry.
- Flag pin retained, both hands accounted for, and no tail.
- Mouth open for his line; closed when listening, with his eyes on the speaker.